Unit 15 · Past simple and past continuous (when) · there / they're / their

Name _____

THE BIG IDEA

The long action in progress uses past continuous; the short action that happens in the middle uses past simple. When joins them.

Длинное действие — past continuous, короткое, которое «вклинилось», — past simple. Их соединяет when.

How we build it

WHICH	PATTERN	EXAMPLE	РУССКИЙ
Long action	was / were + verb-ing	**I was working.**	Я работал.
Short action	past simple	**The phone rang.**	Зазвонил телефон.
Together	When + long action, short action.	**When I was working, the phone rang.**	Когда я работал, зазвонил телефон.
Order	when can go first or in the middle	**I was eating when he arrived.**	Я ел, когда он пришёл.
Comma	comma after a when-part at the START	**When I was eating, he arrived.**	

When we use it

Tell a story: I was waiting when the author came in.
Рассказать историю.

Say what interrupted: The secretary was typing when her boss phoned.
Сказать, что помешало.

Spell: there / they're / their
Выбрать there, they're или their.

REMEMBER

when + a short event (the phone rang) → past simple; the longer action at that time (I was working) → past continuous.

RUSSIAN AND ENGLISH

In Russian «когда я работал, зазвонил телефон» uses the same past for both. In English: long action = was working, short action = rang.

Watch out! We often say...

~~When I worked, the phone was ringing.~~	**When I was working, the phone rang.**
~~I was wait at the library when the author came in.~~	**I was waiting at the library when the author came in.**
~~Their going to see there cousins.~~	**They're going to see their cousins.**
~~Where do you see? (to look)~~	**Where ... / What can you see?**

EASY TRICK

was / were + -ing = the background. Past simple = the sudden event. Also: there (place) · they're (they are) · their (belongs to them).

Try it! Circle the right answer

1. When I ___, the phone rang. (was working / worked)
2. When I was working, the phone ___. (rang / was ringing)
3. They ___ smiling when I went in. (was / were)
4. ___ going to see their cousins. (They're / Their)
5. They will be with ___ cousins. (their / there)
6. I was eating ___ he arrived. (when / then)

Answers: 1 was working · 2 rang · 3 were · 4 They're · 5 their · 6 when